

New Joiner IT Setup Guide

Northgate Group — IT Service Desk Manual | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: IT Operations

1. Scope

This guide describes what IT provides to a new joiner, what the new joiner is expected to complete in the first week, and where to go when something is missing. It is written for the new joiner and for the line manager arranging onboarding.

2. Before the Start Date

The line manager raises an onboarding request at least five business days before the start date. The request must state the start date, the role, the department, the manager's name and whether the joiner will work remotely on any days. Requests raised with less notice are worked on a best-effort basis and equipment may not be ready on day one.

- Company account, mailbox and messaging access created.
- Laptop imaged with the standard build and assigned to the joiner's asset record.
- Headset and docking station allocated, plus a monitor where the role requires one.
- Department distribution lists and access groups applied.
- Remote access group added where the manager has confirmed a remote working pattern.

3. Day One Checklist

- Collect the laptop and peripherals from the IT desk on presentation of the company identity card.
- Sign in with the temporary credential issued by the service desk and set a permanent password that meets the password standard.
- Enrol a multi-factor authentication device before doing anything else; nearly every other system depends on it.
- Connect to the corporate wireless network and confirm the mail client signs in without repeated prompts.
- Connect the VPN once from the office so that the device certificate is issued while on the trusted network.

4. First Week

Install role-specific applications from the Company Portal. Anything not in the catalogue is requested through the process in the Software Access Guide, and the line manager should raise those requests in the first week so that approval and licensing do not delay the joiner.

Confirm access to the shared drives and shared mailboxes the role requires. Missing access is requested as a software issue ticket naming the resource, and the owner of the resource must confirm before access is granted.

5. When Something Is Missing

Raise an IT ticket rather than contacting an administrator directly, so the request is tracked and assigned. Use the request type Hardware Issue for missing or faulty equipment and Software Issue for missing access or applications. Quote the onboarding ticket number in the description so the two can be linked.

A joiner who cannot work at all because equipment or access is missing should have the ticket raised at high priority by the line manager, which brings a first response within two working hours.

6. Leavers and Transfers

The line manager raises an offboarding request at least three business days before the last working day. Accounts are disabled at the end of the last working day, licences are released automatically, and equipment is returned to the IT desk. An employee transferring between departments keeps the same account, and access groups are adjusted rather than recreated.